

Interviewer: That's about it. So, before we start, I'd like to know how you'd like us to give your partner?

Participant : Uh... So we don't give him his real name? Or to...

Interviewer: Is that your preference?

Participant: Er... I don't know if I asked you the question. Well, let's call her back, [Partner].

Interviewer: - All right, [Partner]. So how long have you been with [Partner]?

Participant: Erm... Must be [6-10] years.

Interviewer: - [6-10] years, very good. So, to start with, I'd like you to tell me about your love affair with [Partner], the relationship we're currently living.

Participant: Generally speaking, or in particular?

Interviewer: - Generally speaking, how you met, how it went...

Participant: I could go on for hours about that, no worries. So, basically, we met in high school, we went to the same school, and we've known each other for about 5 seconds, my [1st-5th] year, I'm in year more than her, since [1st-4th] year, and we've been friends for a very long time, we've stayed friends for quite a long time, and so it's only recently that... Well, [6-10] years ago, it's not that recent, that we became a couple a bit by chance, it's a bit by force of circumstance, by getting to know each other, by seeing each other, it happened quite naturally, and that's been a great advantage because we actually knew each other very well before becoming a couple, We've got a friendship that's still very much present, and that helps us a lot in our life as a couple in general, because it's true that very often by default we're going to be in best buddy mode, before being in love mode, and then that helps on many levels. So far, it's going very, very well, and I have to say, since we're married, it's going pretty well, it's going well, and we could say a thousand things about it, but to put it succinctly, it's going very, very well, we're bound to have our problems, it's never perfect every day, but in the very long term, touch wood, but in any case, it's going very, very well, and I like to think that we're both alone. Okay, so how is this new relationship going? We understand each other pretty well, although not all the time. Some days we don't understand each other at all, but we still try, after we've had a row, to talk to each other, to say okay, what happened, why, how, to try to understand each other, to stay on positive lines, to understand each other in a profound way, to understand the values we share. We complement each other just as well, because I know that I'm going to do things that she won't, and vice versa, so we're not going to question each other. We'll allow ourselves moments of laziness, moments of... how to put it... We'll allow ourselves moments of slackness, moments of... let's put it this way: we'll allow ourselves moments of slackness, and then we'll resell the friend side of things, because we know it's normal, we're not always going to be at our best, but by allowing ourselves these moments, we can show each other our weaknesses quite easily, and we can help each other to stand back quite easily. It's not easy to keep that distance, but quite honestly, as the years go by, you can see how the relationship evolves and how easily it can become teleterrestrial. It's very, very quick, but it still holds together very well and I know that it's a support, No, I tell myself that I have complete confidence in her, after all, confidence doesn't exclude control, so I know that conversely, she trusts me, she'll still check what

I'm doing, and conversely, it happens that I make mistakes, we don't look for opportunities to do things, we always do things together and the opportunity is a bit secondary, it's a bit like saying to yourself "we're going to have a good time on Valentine's Day" you really don't know what to do on Valentine's Day, because we have such a good time together so easily and frequently, like giving each other flowers for example, I don't want to wait for an occasion to give you flowers, so basically it's going really well, I've got nothing to complain about. And then you told me that friendship was a big part of our relationship. Oh yes, it really is, I think it defines our relationship best. We're best buddies before we were a couple, and you can really feel that on a day-to-day basis, I think it shows. How does it show, for example? We talk to each other a lot, and when we're with friends, we're very, very, very easy to talk over, and we'll try not to make the others hold a sweater, because I've had my share of making the others hold a sweater, and we'll always be in a dynamic of doing things, activities, having fun, and not just staying between couples, couples separately. We'll have our own little private cocoon, which will be our own little love cocoon, but generally speaking, we'll try to put others at ease, and stay in a friendly dynamic, which won't make people feel uncomfortable.

Interviewer: If you had to compare the quality of your relationship with [Partner] with that of your friends, what would you say?

Participant: I'm trying to get some perspective on it, but I really find it better than the others. With a few exceptions of one or two friends, I'd even be inclined to say just one friend, I'd really put just one couple of friends at about the same level, well at another level of relationship quality, but the others sincerely don't. I find that we have absolutely nothing in common. I find that we have absolutely nothing to envy them, quite the contrary, and I much, much prefer the relationship I have with [Partner], which I see friends have in relationship, even if some have been together for [6-10] years, even if some are married, even if they have children, no despite that frankly I prefer my relationship.

Interviewer: In what way would you say it's better?

Participant: It's hard to say that it's better, because that's a value judgement, but if I were to go too far, I'd say that deep down, we really have the advantage of having been in the same family for a very long time, and of knowing each other well. We don't have any nasty surprises, we know pretty much what to expect, we know each other pretty well, we anticipate each other's reactions pretty easily, we don't get angry for nothing, we know how the other is going to react, We know what makes the other person happy, we know when to let go of our relationship, to take a step back, to leave the other person in his or her corner, and when it's time to come back, there are a lot of things that are quite natural. And I find that's something I see a lot less in other people. After all, it's always a bit complicated, because you only see one side of them, you don't see them every day, so it's tricky. But in any case, from what I can see, I actually prefer my relationship to all that.

Interviewer: So you know your partner very well after all?

Participant: Yeah, clearly.

Interviewer: And then, it seems to me that you mentioned that there were perhaps [1-5] relationships that you would say, you're friends with these relationships.

Participant: So it's true that there are, it's really a relationship, but really a couple of friends where, on a relationship that's very deep, that's really very very beautiful, and the same, they know each other very very well, and they spend very good times together, who are happy together, and I really wouldn't see them without each other. They've known each other since first grade, because they're also old friends. We saw them get together, so it's a combination of things. They were the first to get married, the first to have a child, they were the first to get involved in a lot of projects, they're really, you can see that they're really, really good in their life, they've got their own life, I'm not saying that they'd envy us or that we don't envy them, I'm not saying they'd envy us or that we don't envy them, but it's true that I'd find it harder to put our relationship - and even then, you have to magnify it - above their relationship, saying to myself "well, I think ours is better than theirs", or "oh yeah, no, but really". With some people, I'd say to myself, frankly, I don't envy them, I much prefer our relationship. Right now, I don't envy them, I'm not saying I prefer our relationship, my relationship is just fine as it is, but it's true that if I really had to, once again, magnify the line and note, I'd put them on the same level as our relationship. At least, again, from what I can see.

Interviewer: And you've written, for example, about the fact of having projects together, being married, having children, is that something that's important and that will ultimately contribute to this quality?

Participant: I'd say it depends on people, it depends on each person, it depends on their personal projects. The most important thing, I think, is to be aligned, one with the other, because if one wants children and the other doesn't, it's complicated, if one wants to travel and the other doesn't, it's complicated, if one wants to own, I don't know, a house and the other prefers to live in an apartment, it's complicated. So, it's good to have projects, whatever the project, having a child, a house, a dog, a family, a car, it's not an end in itself. The most important thing is to have the same desires, I think, as the other person. Without talking about concessions, because it's true that there are aspects that are, once again, only my opinion, but which are, in my opinion, too important to really be concessions. Because deep down, it's going to lead to frustration and in the long term, it can be hard to live with, even if you've made the effort for the other person, that's it, it's still an effort, whereas if we're both going in the same direction, we're both looking in the same direction, we're both going in the same direction, it's more natural, we don't ask ourselves the question and then we know we're going to do it. So it's more about having centers to align, projects to align. That's what long-term projects are all about. Because it's true that if [Partner] wanted to live on a houseboat, that would always have been her dream, and that's not the case for me at all. But on that level, it's true that we're heading in the same direction. Our projects are more or less the same, and even if our desires evolve, they evolve at the same time.

Interviewer: Now, if you were to compare your previous relationships, what would you say?

Participant: I find that my previous relationships were much more immature, less mature; they were more youthful relationships, so to speak. If I compare my penultimate relationship, which was my longest relationship before this one, we stayed together for [1-5] years or so, and then we broke up because at a certain point I realized that we weren't going in the same direction. I realized that it wasn't going to be possible in the long term. It's fun every day, but in the very long term, what's the point? And from then on, when I said to myself that it's not possible to plan ahead, in fact no, it didn't work, it didn't stay together. And it's this difference that's really fundamental with the

relationship I have now. Right now, if I take a long-term view, I can't see myself without [Partner]. I don't know, no, I can't imagine. I can't imagine being without her, moving on without her, having relatives without her, or like divorce. We don't even think about it. We don't say to ourselves, okay, maybe and if not, it's unthinkable. And that's what's different about other relationships. If I go back a little further, in the past, longer ago, when I was studying, when I was in high school, other relationships were really... With [Name], they were really love affairs. Their relationship would have lasted a few months, a year, but then... It's funny, for two minutes, but... So there's no long-term vision. Exactly.

Interviewer: Can I ask you how many partners you've had in total?

Participant: In all, [1-5], [6-10], I'd say.

Interviewer: Okay. I'd also like you to tell me what a high-quality relationship means to you. A high-quality relationship? A high-quality relationship... What makes a relationship good? It's not obvious, it's true that it's... Once again, it's quite personal, what makes a relationship qualitative. I tend to say very precise aspects of communication. For me, a relationship is qualitative when there's good communication. Pleasure too, because if you don't take pleasure in being with the person and you're with them out of automatism or habit, it's not interesting. It's not worth it. Stability too, in other words, we're coming back to the question of long-term projection. And finally, having this long-term projection, and saying to yourself "Ok, I'm fine with this person, we're looking in the same direction, we're planning for the long term". For me, this is a truly qualitative relationship. Then there's the temperament and the person in front of you. Because it's true that, even if there were all that, but that, I don't know, let's imagine I'm drawn to a drug problem, for example, directly, it's problems that are... It's an additional problem. It doesn't help the situation. And the fact that we're both going in the same direction too, trying to eat healthily, not drinking, not smoking, or at least not drinking much, eating very healthily, indulging in little pleasures from time to time, that's a lot of problems we're taking away from each other. And it also adds to the quality of the relationship. So it's silly, but it's going to be the little details where I don't say to myself "Gosh, I've got to be careful, I've got to get behind her, because if I don't, we won't pay any attention to that". And conversely, she doesn't say to herself "[Name], he's going to take the night off, he's going out with friends, he's going to drink too much, I'll tell him to be careful, you never know". It's a mutual trust that we know that... In fact, it's a peace of mind we gain. It's really a peace of mind you gain, which I think also adds to the relationship. And then, beyond that, because we're on a practice-to-practice basis, and these are arguments that are a little considered, in quotation marks, but beyond that, the quality, I find there's a somewhat intangible aspect of... It's the right person, it's kind of the... It couldn't work with someone else, someone else could be exactly the same, but here, it's a bit the... It's the right one, it's the right person, you feel good, there's a feeling that's unique of "I feel good with this person, I haven't learned to feel good with this person, I naturally feel good with this person". And all my life, I've always felt good with this person, even as a friend before, and it's inimitable. It's really inimitable, I could have girls who are in every way similar to my partner, but she's not my partner, it's not the same thing, it's different, even if the temperament is more or less the same, or they have the temperament, I don't know, that we idealize, that we'd absolutely love to see, but in fact no, it wouldn't work, because there's this kind of little magic, as well, we'll say. And in terms of quality, there are a lot of little arguments, a lot of little things, but I'd say it's a whole, that's what makes it go

well at the moment, that I find my relationship very qualitative, but it's always the same little arguments.

Interviewer: And when would you say that your relationship, for example, has been stable? Do you have any examples?

Participant: Um...

Interviewer: You can give a few with, for example, food goals and so on.

Participant: Oh, I've got plenty of examples. Well, food, for example, typically, we had a discussion at some point, I'm not sure when, when we said to each other "well, we feel less able to digest certain things". Often, it's a bit of a pity, but we live, so we're more careful. You realize that, for example, I'm much less tolerant of milk. I love drinking milk. So at one point, she said to me "well listen, we're going to buy lactose-free milk, we're going to try to cut down on that, etc." And I said to her "yes, that's a good thing. And I said "yes, it's true that I feel less like eating that". Or red meat. And we eat very little of it, and when we do, it takes us ages to digest, we feel heavy, we don't appreciate it, and so we agree, we say "ok, well, we'll cut back". We're not even going to buy some to eat at home, we eat in restaurants from time to time, but... And we're fine with that, we realize that it gives us pleasure. As for alcohol, at one point we said to ourselves... I love alcohol, I really love quality alcohol, but really, drinking a good bottle is... I deal with whisky, for example. A good bottle of whisky is my little pleasure. And then I realized that a good bottle of whisky lasts for years. The time it takes to finish it is not a good thing. And drinking alone is clearly... So afterwards, it wouldn't really be a problem. But at one point, she said to me "well, listen, we don't have that many friends who come over, who are very, very big fans and who drink a lot. We're going to stop buying it to stock it, it's absolutely useless". And I told him "yes, that's it, we've had a little chat". I told him "well, it's true, you might as well drink it by the glass from time to time, it's more satisfying than stocking up, it's pointless, it's a call to alcoholism". And the communication went well. I know that this kind of subject can be very, very delicate for some couples. But there, well, we discussed it, we came to a common understanding, I mean, even if I'd been alone or in a relationship, I might have said to myself "ok, this is my little pleasure, I'd like to have some nice bottles at home, to treat myself from time to time when I have friends over". But actually, no, the discussion went really well. In the opposite direction, I know that she's also going to make some, not concessions, but small steps where she'll say to herself "ok, it's true that it's good to, I don't know, do sport for example, I like doing sport, I take her with me to a lot of sporting activities". And if she's feeling lazy, because it's going to be less hot and the wind is monstrous, she'll follow me much more easily. Because I'm going to sign up for a 10 km race, she'll say to herself "ok, I don't feel like it, but come on, it could be fun, go back to [Location], we'll train, these are extra things we can do together". And that's it. And then there are the expenses in general. She's very structured and rigorous, and she's very careful. I'm a lot less basic when it comes to that, but she still gave me that structure. And since then, I've had an Excel spreadsheet with 25 tabs to manage everything financial, which works very well. I know it's given her peace of mind. It's been a plus for me, because in the end, it's allowed me to structure that aspect. And we're making the middle ground. I know that she's always worried when we're going to spend a lot of money, even if we can, even if we've drunk the ether, we've got a lot of savings put aside, it's going to go smoothly, we've got the means. She'll always say "yes, but it's expensive". And I always want to tell her "okay, don't worry, it's going to be fine, it's going to be a happy medium".

I've spent more without her, she's spent more without me, and in the end, we end up with a happy medium. And we're both very happy, we don't regret what we're doing, the vacations we're going on, what we're buying. And things are going extremely well, there's no frustration on either side in that respect. So it's a matter of listening and ultimately making decisions that suit both parties. That's it, that's it. It's often a discussion, it's not even... It's very rarely... We're very rarely going to do... I've lost my word. I've lost my word, my God. Concessions. We're rarely going to make concessions, it's always going to be pretty fluid. We'll naturally do the thing that works for both of us, and then we'll get better at it. I think it's kind of nice because you can see yourself getting better. Take procrastination, for example. We'd beaten procrastination, so it wasn't easy, but now when we have to do something, we do it straight away. Whether it's me or her, if I say to her "you've got to do this", I do it straight away, it's the other way round. We've also overcome the storage problem. Not at all, we try to be fairly minimalist, and it works quite well. It's an everyday job, but it's something we do together. It started from... I'm not going to say what it started from, but it's a whole bunch of elements where we say to ourselves "But in the end, in fact, I wouldn't have been with her, my life would have been fundamentally different". But really, on every level.

Interviewer: Do you have any counter-examples to all this, in terms of communication, stability, etc.?

Participant: Counter-examples...

Interviewer: When there was perhaps less communication, less...

Participant: This morning, for example. It happens quite often that we don't necessarily understand each other, because it's going to be for lots of reasons. We're stressed, we didn't sleep well, we're a bit hungry, we didn't eat well, we're bloated, we're under external stress, and in fact, we're not going to listen to each other. And typically, this morning, we had to make an appointment, and we had to discuss the date. It's silly, it's really silly. And we discuss it, and in fact, we don't understand each other. We didn't understand each other, we didn't listen to each other, we stayed for an hour, and it turned out to be a big headache that could easily have been avoided, because in the end, we just didn't understand each other. We just didn't understand each other, but in the end, we agreed on a date. And in the end, we talked it over, we huffed and puffed, we drank, we ate cookies, and it worked out. But it's true that we're trying to sort it out faster and faster, because we see that, as the situation progresses, we try to find solutions, to say to ourselves "OK, we'll try to take a break, take some time, stop arguing about it". And it's true that whereas before, an argument could last 4 hours, now, in one hour, we've covered everything, we've discussed everything, it's all been sorted out, and we don't get frustrated. But it's true that this morning, we listened to each other, there was zero communication, that's for sure, we didn't listen to each other at all. But you know, there are other deconflicts when there are. Yeah, really, we don't have any conflicts that, in my opinion anyway, drag on and on. Very little dissatisfaction or frustration, I don't mean none at all, because you never know, you have to keep a small margin of error. But I don't think we've managed to... Ah, OK. I thought you'd cut it. Ah OK, well, nickel. So no, no, no, I'd say almost no, 99% of the time, almost no worries, as long as it stays. And that's also thanks to the communication we're taking from you. Yes, it makes the communication.

Interviewer: And now, the opposite version, what would a low-quality relationship be for you?

Participant: For me, a low-quality relationship starts with listening. When it comes to communication, it's going to be a couple who don't listen to each other. In a really opposite direction, it's going to be one of the two people who likes to go out, do things, and have a social life that's perhaps very hectic, and the other who prefers to be in his corner quietly. Or one who likes to spend a lot, and the other not at all. One who wants to travel, and the other who is sedentary. One who loves sport, and the other not at all, but by forcing themselves. Because it's not necessarily about doing the same thing, it's about not necessarily listening to the other's wishes, and learning after a few months or years that, in fact, you're still in the house, but the other never liked it. I've seen plenty of examples of couples with friends who don't have the same hobbies, the same pastimes, but no worries, everyone has their own little secret garden, and the same goes for me and my wife. I don't know, for example entrepreneurship, I know that the wing doesn't believe in it at all. It's an activity I like, but I respect it, I say okay, I'm not going to give my opinion, I wouldn't have done it like that, we know we'd never have been able to work together, but the important thing is to listen to each other, to say okay, it doesn't matter, we're not going to get worked up about it, everyone has their own little secret garden, we don't have to talk about it. For me, a low-quality reaction would be to force yourself to do things, and I'd also say to sacrifice yourself, or at least to have the feeling of sacrifice in relation to the other person, to say to yourself ok, I've done so much for you, I've sacrificed myself for you. I think this can lead in many situations to a negative situation in the end, because there's someone who sees himself sacrificing himself, who perhaps has expectations, frustrations, and at some point it's a mental load that builds up, and at some point you have to release the pressure, at some point it'll come out and it's bound to hurt. So I think that can also play a part in the low quality. The physical aspect too, it's true that it's not mentioned at all, but there has to be a physical attraction too, of course, because otherwise it can be... otherwise it's a roommate, which is a bit of a shame anyway. The aspect... well, it's silly, but the intellectual aspect too, it's not as silly as that in fact, we realize, we've realized to a lesser extent that in fact we can't, we couldn't have a loving reaction, we find it hard to have a relationship with people with whom we have too big an intellectual gap. In other words, if... and we've already had the case, she's already worked as a temp in factories, so she's not criticizing people who work in factories, but she told me "but I see the difference, well it's gossip, you don't want to go and have a drink with people you meet in that environment, If there's too big a gap, it doesn't work, you don't know what to say to the person, and conversely, the person is going to find you just as annoying, they're going to think "well, it's not funny". The same goes for couple relationships, too big gaps, very complicated, very very complicated I think to reduce. I don't know if it's low quality, but there's another aspect that's not absolute - again, it's my point of view, but I have the impression that it also plays a role - and that's the gap. I've always had the impression that in many situations, although this isn't always the case, again, you're full of couples where there's a big gap and it's not a problem, I don't know if it's the exception that proves the rule, but these big gaps sometimes lead to differences in desires. For example, one person is going to have a child much earlier than the other, or I see myself buying because my biological age is early, I want to do this project or that project and not the other, and in fact there's a very, very big gap. And conversely, one person is about to retire and the other isn't, and the dynamics aren't identical at the same time, and I have the impression that this can be a big hindrance. And then it's still, I know pretty much everything, it's still a lot of arrivals, but that's more or less what I see. So, for example, you've entered at the foot of the sacrifice lesson and the gap can translate into a difference in desire, so to speak.

Interviewer: Yes, that's right. Was there perhaps a moment when you had one of these elements in your relationship?

Participant: In my current relationship? Yes. Well, the separation, no, because we're [1-5] months apart, we've got a school year, but that's [1-5] months apart in reality. We don't want either of us to make sacrifices for the other that are, how can I put it, excessive, or without a good reason, or that it's a sacrifice, a sacrifice that's going to weigh heavily on our hearts. Then I have some counter-examples, typically we moved [1-5] year ago to the region where we are now, we were both, we had work to do, we knew our colleagues, our environment, we were fine where we were. Then I had a professional opportunity that you can't say no to, you really can't say no to. And [Name] followed me, she was working in a firm, and she thought, well, they already know me, I'm starting from scratch, it's complicated. But I was told, don't think of it as a sacrifice, it's still a great opportunity, a very, very great opportunity that for the moment I don't regret. We've been rebuilding things for [1-5] year now, but the fact that she doesn't see it as a sacrifice helps a lot. She doesn't tell me, she doesn't say I've come to follow you. Even if she did tell me at the outset, I'm following you, but you'd better be sure. In other words, you don't tell me in [1-5] months' time, I don't like it, I'm leaving. So yes, you're on board, but it has to be for a good thing. But it's true that if it hadn't been for the notion of sacrifice that we'd already tackled, that we'd already defused, it could have been very problematic. It's really the kind of thing where, at the slightest frustration, one of us repeats to the other, "Look, I came here for you, but now I'm all alone, I've got no friends, I don't know anyone, it sucks, I don't like it, it's cold". And that's just the beginning, and it can be tricky. Decisions have to be made in agreement with both people. Exactly. I'd also like you to tell me about the things we've talked about in terms of the quality of the relationship, i.e. communication and so on. If not, what are the most important things for you in a love relationship, or if there are others. The things that are most important in a relationship, other than communication, because I think I've talked about that for at least 20 minutes out of the 30 minutes. I'd like to spend time together, to have quality time, that's really important. It doesn't have to be times when we're just on the sofa, next to each other, each on our phones, but times when we want to be close to each other, with contact. We're not going to say to each other "we're going to do something for the sake of doing something", but we're really going to try to have a good time. We'll be able to say to each other "okay, I know the other person can surprise me" with outings, with "it could also be a gift, a little something". I know she's mentioned something to me twice, for example, "ah I'd like to have that, that could be nice", or "ah I'm missing something", and then I say to myself "ok that's good". There's a message, and just as I know there are things I wouldn't buy for myself, there are things I know I wouldn't buy for myself, but for example, I'll take a very simple example: I love Legos. I love Legos, it's really my pleasure. But I'm always going to find a thousand things to do with my money before I buy Legos, so if they weren't offered to me, I'd never buy them. And it's something that gives me infinite pleasure, but more than anything else. And that's it, and even if it's a very small thing, a tiny thing, but it always gives me pleasure, and it's always the little surprise. I always say to myself "stop buying me stuff because she's going to get sick of it", and all that, plus it takes up space everywhere, but in fact it doesn't, and it's always a little surprise. Or a little weekend, I don't know, we'll go for a walk in a town, go to an opera, go to a nice little restaurant, and have a good time, it's always going to be unreal, and those are the little moments when I think it's very important to have them. Otherwise, on a day-to-day basis, I think there are aspects that are once again very practical, we've already talked about them, but managing the budget together is important, money is an era of war, but



these are the beginnings of the end, if things don't work out on that level, they won't work out for the rest. We don't have any worries about household chores, because we're two maniacs, we're big maniacs, so that's fine, but it's an aspect that I've seen very often in other couples that posed problems, because one doesn't like to do it, one tidies up more than the other, etc. And it's true that it can be a real problem for a couple. And it's true that it can be quite tricky. Sex too, frankly, means knowing how to renew yourself, always taking pleasure, listening to each other, trying things out, knowing how to surprise each other, just having a sex life in general, being open too. When at some point we've thought about it and said to ourselves that we'd rather discuss the day when we're more physically attracted to each other, or feel like going elsewhere, or I don't know, but say to ourselves ok, it's better to openly engage in libertarianism, go and say ok, we still love each other, we're staying together, but from a purely sexual and purely physical point of view we feel like going to see someone else. Once we'd said okay, frankly, we'd rather say that than make a mistake, we realized that we couldn't make a mistake. There's no reason to make a mistake. How could we? Anyway, we've already allowed ourselves that. We've already given ourselves permission to talk about it, to tell each other if there's ever a need. And it's not just saying it for the sake of saying it, we really realize that sometimes we've already gone so far as to say, well, what if with what's-his-name, or what if with [Name], and in fact, it's a plus, but absolutely monstrous. I know that from a sexual point of view, I don't see how there could be any frustration from that. Even if, apart from that, we also allow ourselves to say that we'd like to try this or that, and not many things we haven't tried yet. And that plays a big part too. And in the end, you realize that it's very qualitative. It's not worth getting laid every day, because clearly, it's better to be on the qualitative side and say to yourself, okay, you've got an absolutely fulfilling sex life. At that level, we don't ask ourselves questions, we don't go and see other people, we don't say to ourselves "Hm, look at that guy, what does she think?" And in fact, no. We know that one way or the other, it's okay at that level. And that, I think, is also very, very important, and it's something that after a while, in [6-10] years, you can let go very easily. In [6-10] years, you can very easily pay more attention to your looks and not just your looks, but also to your ability to attract the other person and still make them vibrate. But it's true that it's a problem for every gender. That's pretty important. I think it's an aspect that's really... It's too often neglected, but it still plays a big part, I think. Yes, sex life is going to be important. Yes, it is. And also, the moments when it looks like, the attentions... That's it. Without falling into a relationship where we're necessarily going to give each other gifts, because that's... Well, first of all, it's materialistic. Secondly, it's not minimalist. We're minimalists, so it's very complicated. And... In fact, it's also a question of desire and need. My desires are not his desires. We don't have the same needs either. She may be very into activities, experiences. She'll appreciate it when I take the time and trouble to organize something, to please her. As for me, maybe I want to be more about recognition. To have her acknowledge me and say "OK, that's good. That's what you've done, I'm proud of you. You've made good progress." And once we've understood that and talked too, it helps a lot.

Interviewer: Now, I'd like you to tell me, drawing a little on your own experiences, what love means to you.

Participant: So, what does love mean to me? Well, we think of ourselves as a couple, as friends, as love in general. So, for me, it's a feeling. Okay, I'm not going out on a limb here. What is love? For me, it's a feeling. It's a deep feeling. It's a feeling that lasts. It's a feeling that's quite unique. Personally, I make a distinction between friendship and love. I don't say to myself that you love someone, that you're a friend. I love my mates, but I don't see it as love. For me, I see it more as...

Well, it's a separate feeling. You can have love for your partner, love for your parents, your siblings for example. Because you're going to have a child, you're going to love your child. It's going to be a different kind of love than the love you have for your partner. But I see it more as love than a friendly relationship. For me, love is really about the long term. It's what lasts after the red-hot, honeyed period, the crush period when it's really love at first sight, we're really into each other, sex is three times a day. It's the beginning, it's really... What remains afterwards in the very long term, for me, is really love. It's really the... We're together, not because we're used to being together, a bit like our parents at one time, they'd been together for [36-40] years. But it seems like they were never happy. But really, I'm with this person and I'm happy with this person. I don't need anything else. Frankly, to be on a desert island, the two of us, I'd be fine with that. To be in a gutter, but as long as it's just the two of us, I'm fine with it. For me, that's really it. I'm with the right person. I can't see myself with anyone else. I know that I love this person and that my love will evolve over time, of course. We get older, we change, that's life. But I'm not afraid of growing old because I'm with this person. I'm not afraid of the future because I'm with that person. I enjoy every moment, every second, when I hear the sound of his voice or smell his scent, I know that there, I know that there, that's love. It's with friends. I'm happy to be with my mates. I'm very happy. But if I had to choose a person with whom I could only talk to one person for the rest of my life, I wouldn't even think about it. The question wouldn't even arise. I think that sounds like a pretty good definition. It's a very deep feeling.

Interviewer: There are a lot of dimensions to what we're saying. How important would you say love is in a relationship?

Participant: In a relationship? In a relationship? In a relationship? I'm a smart guy. I think you can be in a relationship without love. Some people get there for all sorts of reasons. Because they have relationships that are almost symbiotic. They're really people who go well together. They're good together. They bring things to each other. It's an exchange that suits them very well. It's a balance that suits them very, very well. After that, I think there are a lot of ways to have a fulfilling relationship. There are lots of ways. There are people who get married who don't necessarily love each other, or don't love each other more than that. And one doesn't prevent the other. Personally, I couldn't see myself in a relationship with someone without love, but real love. It wouldn't be possible. It wouldn't be an idea. It wouldn't be an idea. It wouldn't be a solution, a possibility. Now, I'm just saying that maybe if I'd been in a different situation and never found my other half, I wouldn't have said the same thing. I mean, it depends on each person. I think everything is possible. In any case, there's everything and you can find everything in nature. I think there are lots of possibilities.

Interviewer: So it's not necessarily a necessity. But it's still very important to you?

Participant: For me, it's still very important. To be with a person, because it's really... How can I put it? It's the person you're going to spend the most time with in your life. Not so long ago, there were charts that showed, it's a bar graph that showed with columns the amount of time you spent with different people. This is something that happened a few years ago, it's quite recent. It shows the time spent with siblings, parents, friends and colleagues, over a 90-year period. We're going to be about, to make a good average. And also with your spouse, you'll realize that once you've spent [16-20] years, you've spent 90% of your time with your parents. Your siblings maybe a little less, you

have a little more time to spend with your brothers and sisters, in the world, you have some, your friends, you see them relatively frequently, your colleagues, it's only during the professional period, anyway, it's shy. But if you find your partner early on, he's the person you spend the most time with. On average, you'll spend 8 hours a day with your partner. After that, it depends on how you work and so on. The other, his activities. But it's the person you spend the most time with in life, I think. It's important, it's important for me, that it's the right person, and that it's not someone you tolerate, or someone you're with because... well, you're with them because... But no, that it's really, if it's obvious, and I wouldn't see it any other way, if my daughter died tomorrow, and I found myself all alone, I don't know if I'd get back together with someone, saying to myself, well, you shouldn't stay all alone, or you should stay open, I wouldn't know, I'm not in the situation, so it's hard to say, ok, I'd do it that way. But I can't imagine it, at least, to this day, I can't imagine it. I can't imagine that it would be possible to live differently. We're talking about love here, so we know that there are different ways of loving and expressing love. How do you know that your partner, your matrix, loves you? She already tells me. She'll always do what she thinks is best, and what she thinks will please me the most. I can see it too, when you don't like someone, you don't like the person, she really doesn't make the effort to give her the impression that it's not lying, so it shows straight away. But in general, as soon as I tell her something she doesn't want, I can see it right away. When I suggest something she wants, or she has a particular desire, I can see it straight away too. She's pretty transparent in that respect. Her well-being too, her stress in general, when it's not... Because we used to be friends. It's true that this is an argument where I've seen her in a relationship with other people. And I've seen what she's like. I see her relationship, and I can now, with time, because we've known each other for a while, see when she's more or less fulfilled and when she's not. I know that there are things, aspects in which she doesn't blossom, aspects in which she blossoms much more, moments when she's better than others, whether it's not necessarily in relation to couples, but in relation to work, in relation to friends, in relation to family. After that, I could be wrong about all that, as for the measure that she herself doesn't have so much any more, and finally, in fact, she has doubts. Maybe, frankly, maybe. So you can never really be sure, you're not in the other person's head. That's the feeling too. I mean, she spends a lot of time and we spend a lot of time together. We butt heads, we argue, it happens. But despite that, it's not going to stop us from talking to each other and talking to each other again quickly, because it's hard to stay away from each other. And here we are, when she's going to tell me lots of little things, me, messages at work, because she's thought of something, way to do things with me and not with other friends because we're going to do things, activities, go out or have friends over. We'll be doing this for two days. We'll get tired of it, we'll stop. We'll say we're good together and then, for a while, we'll do things that we're both good at and avoid everyone because we've filled our social quota. And this kind of thing makes me say "OK, she's fulfilled her social quota, but she still wants to see me. We're still going to spend time together. We don't fit into each other's social quota." And I tell myself that this would be the moment when, yes, she'd need to distance herself more, that she'd need to... that she'd feel less comfortable with me, that she'd need more time with friends, that she'd find in other people what she wouldn't find in me. Then I'd worry more and say to myself "Ah OK, what's going on? Why is this happening? Maybe things aren't going as well, maybe she's not feeling as well, maybe the love is fading a little." And then I'd worry, but I don't worry too much and I also have the impression, because she's told me, and also because I experience it every day, that we're continuing to make efforts, efforts on many aspects, on many subjects, trying to stay up to date, to listen to each other, staying in shape, continuing to be able to help each other, to listen to each other's desires and

needs, to plan for the long term, to provide security for each other, a whole host of little things in fact, that keep the laziness going, basically, we keep putting wood in the fireplace. It seems to work pretty well. It's tiring, but it works. Yes, so it's the intentions and the way you see her ultimately acting with you, my friend. Yes, frankly, if I didn't give her what she needed, I don't think she'd give it back to me like that. And conversely, if she took the piss out of me all the time, she never had a little action for me, she was never happy with what she was doing, she criticized me all the time, I wouldn't want to please her every time, I wouldn't give my all to everything I do. I wouldn't be saying to myself "the environment has to be super clean and tidy, there's this to tidy up, I'll do it like this, she's not thinking about it, I'll get ahead of it, I feel she's a bit tired, there I'll make the meal and do something that pleases her, or I'll anticipate, so she'll say 'great, there's nothing to do this weekend'. And in the sense that you have the other person, it works, because you're taking care of the other person, quote-unquote.

Interviewer: Yes, the actions of another have an impact on the other. I'd like you to tell me about one of the last positive interactions you had with [Name].

Participant: One of the last positive interactions? Well, just before I came here, I brought her a glass of water and she was so happy. After that, it's up to the individual, it's a little something. She's got an appointment with a patient, so we're both on video, she's in the office, I set up the PC for her, I hooked up the webcam, I brought her a glass of water, oh yes I gave her her health too earlier, I forgot. She was happy. I offered to make her a cup of tea beforehand, because I was making myself a coffee. Well, she said she didn't feel like it, but 10 minutes later she said she'd like a cup of tea, and she felt a bit embarrassed, a bit annoyed, because she thought "well, it's true that I said earlier that I didn't feel like it, but now I do". And it didn't bother me, I didn't renege, I made her tea because it gives me pleasure to please her, and she was very happy. She really appreciated it, she had her tea, I prepared everything for her, and she was able to relax for a while before her appointment. And it's going to be little touches like that, where I know she's happy, and I know that when she's finished, she'll be happy and she'll ask me how it went from my side, and then it's super positive. And what do you think made this interaction positive? What was the factor? She didn't feel judged, she really didn't feel judged, she felt free to ask me anything. It's a bit like a child, if you make fun of a child, when he asks questions, he doesn't ask any more. But if you answer, you're still looking, the child keeps asking questions. I ask questions absolutely at [21-25], I've really lived. And there, giving the ground to the request, there's something that pleases her, that makes her feel better. She feels she can ask, even if it's not all the time, it's once in a while, she won't do it every time. Sometimes, she'll say to herself, okay, I don't feel like going in right away, but maybe later on, so I'll say yes anyway. But right now, she's feeling pretty confident, she's free enough to ask, to say, okay, I know I'll be asking later, but I'm asking you now. And she's happy about that, it's a very fertile ground for positive, natural, non-thinking relationships and interactions. Because otherwise, afterwards, when he says to himself, I'm going to amend that, he's going to think that, the last time, it upset him. It's a mental burden on top of that, it's useless. And here, we don't have that mental load, so we don't ask ourselves the question. Yes, trust, no, it's so... Exactly. And on the contrary, will you have the last negative interaction you had? This morning, when we argued. It was... Well, since then, when things settled down, things got a lot better, we ate, we had a pizza, we had little moments, little moments together, little moments apart, and then things settled down pretty well. But it's true that this morning, we'd slept a little badly, we weren't feeling very well, we had to make some decisions, we were on the verge of a chapter in our lives that... What can I say? Every time you do something new,

you always feel a little dizzy at the start. As a result, we were in a bad position to plan our appointments. And what would make it a negative interaction? It was really the lack of listening, we both felt frustrated, not listened to, judged, it bothered us, it made us tense pretty quickly, we both felt not understood, we felt cut off every time, we cut each other off when we spoke, not respected almost, and it was pretty unpleasant on both sides. The lack of communication and listening.

Interviewer: I'd like you to talk about the challenges you face in your relationship?

Participant: Every day. Every day, really, it's... For me, it's... I think of it a bit like driving. It's a bit like driving. It's so easy. At some point, you know how to do it, you're used to it, you do it naturally. But I think it's a bit like driving. But you have to stay focused, that's important. It's when you stop paying attention to what you're doing that accidents happen easily. And for me, the challenge of the move, every day, the challenge of love really every day, is to stay focused and pay attention to everything at all times. I know that without over-interpreting, but when she tells me "yeah, I wanted that", she'll be happy. It's not necessarily going to bother her that I don't, but if I stop paying attention to what she's telling me or what she needs, she's going to feel less loved, less pampered, less pampered, less listened to. She'll feel less privileged than others. She's going to say to herself "yeah, but hey, they're crazy, we're married, it's okay, they don't give a damn anymore, they don't make an effort". And it's always a challenge to stay focused. The same goes for aspects. I know there are aspects of my personality that I absolutely can't stand, that's for sure. But conversely, there are bound to be aspects of our personality to which we pay a little attention because we know that it can irritate the other person. So we pay attention to them. She knows that, for example, her side... Well, she tends to get carried away rather quickly. So a temper, she'll get angry quickly. And she's working on it. I know she's working on it, and it's really not easy. She's been working on it for years. But it's a moment-by-moment effort, paying attention to it. And I have a little list of things I do that bother her. I've got plenty of them, but I don't know how to even... listen. Really listen. And when we have a discussion, really take the time to listen to what she's telling us and not to make assumptions before "Come and understand", to validate with her and to... really, really listen to what she's saying, which wasn't always the case. There was a time when I'd listen to the beginning of what she was saying and then... "Come on, I've got it." And maybe that even happened to me on the... on the work side. On the work side, I was less attentive and it's true that I tend to rush into things quite easily. And these are aspects where, well, it's every day. You have to pay attention to it every day, because it's an aspect of your personality. It's a real challenge. It's not trivial. But you know why you do it, you know it pleases the other person, you know it's not a good thing anyway. These are all aspects of your personality that you have to work on. You try to strive for perfection. And... Yeah, but that's... It's not easy. And then, beyond that, the rest... A real challenge is also knowing how to give the other person what they need. I know that she has a tendency to be... A tendency to stress quite easily. She needs a solid foundation in many areas. In other words, I know that we can't both be... We can't both doubt, we can't both worry, it's not possible. One of us can, but not both of us. And... She'll worry quickly, because... "Ah but yes, but did we leave any money aside? Did we leave the emergency savings? What if something happens, and then... Ah, but this insurance, is it good? Did we take it out properly? What kind of guarantee do we have? What if, in a few years' time, we realize that it won't even cover the other one? Or what if... I don't know, but it... It's going to be expensive. Is that a problem? Or maybe our relationship with such and such a family is a bit complicated. Can we alienate them or not? Shouldn't we agree to bring it back? And... There will always be moments when... She's going to need moral support, material support, safety support.

She'll say to herself, "Okay, I've got my pillar, I've got a certainty in life". That's it, it's a certainty, it's good, I'm not worried, it's there, there's a certainty. And I know it's not always easy to give him that, but... It offers him, once again, it's like having a safe playground for a child, where the child can... He knows his parent is watching him, he can... He lets go, he goes. And conversely, I have the same... The same needs, a little differently, but for example, I know that as long as I have her recognition, I don't need anyone else's recognition. And it's also a... It's very conducive, I'm not particularly worried, from a professional point of view for example, or in my relationships with other people. Okay, as long as I have her approval, the others in the end, it's not that I don't care, but it doesn't affect me, I don't say to myself... I don't want to please anyone else. So, in your opinion, it's also a big plus. Yes. Yes. But then, if I go back to the challenges you mentioned, I have the impression that the most important thing is to remain attentive, and pay attention to the other person. That's it, it's staying focused, being attentive, and giving the other person what they need. And then, yes, being a pillar, which is what you said too. And... Excuse me.

Interviewer: Precisely, were there any challenges you've already overcome in the past?

Participant: Challenges we've met in the past, yes, different ones. We've already lived at a distance, in [Country], for example. We were already living together, we had an apartment, but then we moved because of the vagaries of work, projects and so on. You moved to [Country A], they live there in [Country B], I moved to [Country C]. And that makes for a long-distance relationship. We also had an apartment in [Country A], so in fact we moved between [1-5] countries, and [1-5] places to live, and we hardly saw each other, so it's true that it's a long-distance relationship that you have to... It's not easy. Plus we had other challenges, because it's not fair... I'm in [City A], she's in [City B], no, it's really... It's complicated, it was really complicated, we hardly saw each other. We've been through this, well, moving, we've moved a lot, a lot, a lot, and each time it's always... You start from scratch, you make new friends, it's hard to keep the relationships you had before, because you're no longer here. So it's always a challenge to move, to start all over again. And the last move we made to get to where we are today was the hardest, because she kind of gave up on everything, saying to herself "Ok, I trust you, and then we'll go". But it's not all for nothing. One of the biggest challenges we've had is the wedding too, I almost forgot, yeah, the wedding. It was [1-5] year and a half of... It was very complicated. We were fine. Luckily we had each other's backs, but really, with everything else, it was a long way from [Name]'s, wasn't it? Everything that could go wrong did go wrong. We had a year and a half of preparations, and fortunately we had wedding planners, and fortunately, but it was a nightmare on every level, and that was really the challenge. That was the biggest challenge we had. Yeah, it was a challenge, the wedding. Oh yes, really, it was... Everything that could have happened to us, did. Earlier, we talked a little bit about conflict, and I'd like to talk a little bit more about deconflicting any discussions you might have.

Interviewer: So I'd like you to tell me about it, whether it's by frequency, how often can it happen?

Participant: Conflicts... Headaches, I'd say, once a month. Come on, twice a month or so, once or twice a month.

Interviewer: And then, what might be the objects that are really most in demand in principle?

Participant: It's always... It's always subjects with no substance. It's really a listening problem, where we don't listen to each other, and we're always a bit on meta-communication, rather than on the

substance of what we're saying to each other. We agree on the substance of what we're saying, but it's really, we haven't listened to each other, we've brought frustration to each other, and we get angry, "Ah, but you said that, and I said that, and in fact, yes, but I want to say that." These are bottomless subjects, and every time, it's a listening problem. And afterwards, you still have to solve them. Yes, you get to a point where you say to yourself, "Okay, we've been at each other's throats, we're arguing, it's not going well, we don't understand." And at the end, you say to yourself, "Well, then you've got the basics, we were talking about this, and if we find a solution, it's no big deal, after we apologize, the little hug, and then come on, we try to start on something positive, we eat a little something, we watch an episode of something, we spend a little time, and then it gets better." We get to that finger time every time. There's no worry where we've said, "No, we've never sorted that out, and then it pays off in my heart." It's more a question of communication, and after a moment spent together? We put a positive spin on it, we communicate well on it, we realize that in fact there's no problem, and that we just weren't listening to each other, we give each other the ear we want, we apologize, and then afterwards we realize that, in fact, it wasn't a big deal.

Interviewer: And apart from this communication, and these moments spent together, what other means do you use to maintain your relationship?

Participant: We maintain our relationship in terms of... In general? In general. How do you maintain your relationship? Oh yeah, lots of ways. We play sports together. Not just sports. We have little moments together, typically, this evening, project, she dances. Tomorrow, she'll be relaxing at home, enjoying herself, while I'll be at judo, so we'll have activities and times when we're not together at all. We're going to have lots of activities together, we're going to play tennis together, go running together, go hiking together. Projects. We love to travel, we're big travelers, so we're always going to embark on a travel project. We always have a course. And when we've signed up for one, we're off on a new travel project. It's very enjoyable. Games. Games, games, games. We play either board games, because it's hard to find any, so generally, when we don't feel like doing anything, we sit down and play knots together, and then it just... relaxes us. It's either duo games on mobile, or on PC, it'll be MMOs, shooters, we'll both play. We have periods when we play a lot, and others when we don't at all. What else is it going to be? Outings, where we'll say to ourselves, okay, well, what's the cultural thing to do? We'll say to ourselves, well, we'll look at all the museums, for a month, two months, we'll do lots of museums, lots of cultural outings, meet people, go out, see friends, and then it's activities that keep us going, and that change. They also put us on our toes a lot, a lot, a lot, a lot, a lot. Finding new ways to eat and enjoy ourselves, discovering new restaurants every time, we love that. It's very important to us, it's a bit of a business, it's always going to please us, and as soon as we get a taste for one or the other, come on, we'll have a bite to eat. We'll know for sure that this restaurant is our favorite, so we'll go there. Yesterday, for example, we tried out a new one, which came as a big surprise. What else is there? Lots of activities, things we do together, and surprises. Typically, she's turning [26-30] this year, so it's a good thing she can't hear me. I'm planning a surprise with her friends, so we can do something fun that we've never done before. I know it'll please her, and that's always the... She remembers the last time I did something for her, and I remember the last time she did something for me, and she surprised me, and it's always a pleasure actually, we love it. And we know we'll always... We're not going to do it systematically, but... We're not going to wait until we forget the last time, I don't know, it was the last time she surprised me. We're not going to have time to forget, so that also plays a big part. And on a day-to-day basis, making life easier, anticipating each other's needs: she's tired, I'm making dinner, I'm tired, she's

going to clean up, we're going to share the chores, we're going to try to do a whole bunch of things, as soon as we say we have to do this, that, that, if there's a moment to do it, and I'm really busy, she's going to do it, because things have to be taken down to the cellar, this has to be put away, that has to be done, this or that has to be cleaned. So we leave each other lots of time, we find we have free time, and it's super nice to say, "Wow, we do lots of activities, we work, we have a social life, and we balance each other out well enough to say we each have a full life, we both have time to do our activities." And it even allows us to say, "Hello, we have a child." I can't imagine what it must be like to have a child, I don't know what it's like, but we don't say to each other, "Oh boy, we'll stop living from now on." You just say to yourself, "I know I can count on the other person, I'm not worried, it won't stop me from being able to play sports, see friends, have time for myself." And that's priceless. Yes, it's important to have a balance between time for oneself and time spent with... With the roof. And on the contrary, I'd like to know what could make you leave your partner? Um... I don't know, frankly, I don't know. I'd be inclined to say, even if, no, but maybe cheating. So even if she did cheat on me, I'd feel... Yeah, I'd feel cheated on, but I'd think, "But why did she cheat on me? What's going on here? Did I do something wrong? Does she want to go somewhere else and figure it out?" At that point, we'd go back to the question of libertarianism and say to ourselves, "Bah listen, maybe in fact, sexually, we want to go and see someone else, or it could be because she hasn't had the listening she needs." If not, what could it be? Maybe not the lie, because... We're pretty... We try to be open about it too, because it always happens to... to brush the truth under the carpet a bit, not to feel good about something, not to necessarily tell everything. You don't have to tell everything, it's normal to have your own little secret garden. So it's totally understandable. I don't think it's going to be a big problem. Besides, we've both learned that we lied to each other about something and didn't tell each other about it. Because we're not proud of it, or because, yeah, it's not a good thing, or because, yeah, I don't want to talk about it. What else could make us leave? It'd be Gamecheat, wouldn't it? It would be Gamecheat. I think that would be the main reason. After that, it would be the change, if... I don't know, that she stopped going altogether, that she became really different, that she stopped trying at all, that she became what she hated in other people. Maybe, and again, I'm telling myself that no, in any case, you mustn't give up, because it's a little more difficult or the other person is having a hard time. It's like with friends, you don't let a friend down just because he's taken a wrong turn and things aren't going well. It can last for years, of course. But what's a few years in a lifetime? So, I don't know, that seems the most likely thing, but I really don't think so. Yeah, a drastic change. Yeah, that's it, a really big let-go, really. If she went totally live, then yes, I'd be thinking, OK, I've got to deal with a child, she's doing anything, she's in the middle of a crisis. But then, with hindsight, I'd think, well, she needs help. She's not doing well if she's acting like this. So it's time not to abandon her and not to leave her. After that, I don't know how I'm going to react to the situation. Yes.

Interviewer: And as for the benefits of the relationship, would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Participant: Totally, 100%, without a shadow of a doubt. From a mental point of view, from a physical point of view, from an ideological point of view, from a practical and technical point of view, it's given me structure, it's given me serenity, it's given me organization on many levels, it helps me to be much more punctual, much more efficient, much more fastidious physically. It also pushes me to do sport, to stay really fit, to surpass myself, to do activities, to meet people, to always improve, to always train, to always stay alert to everything, to try to keep good relations with my family and



to maintain deeply healthy relationships. Frankly, absolutely at every level. Yes, on a day-to-day basis too, you were telling us, for example, that the idea of framing yourself... Yes, clearly. If I do something that's not going well, or if I let myself go on a subject, she tells me straight out, "Listen, you're not making any sense, you've got to pull yourself together, you've got something to do, you told me you'd do something, you'd do this, or you'd finish your statements at such and such a time, or you'd talk to something, you'd deal with this subject, well you deal with it." And there's no question of procrastinating, of saying to yourself "ok, well, I'll do it later, it's no big deal." So on a day-to-day basis, well... Yes, so for you, it's a good relationship that brings you something on your side, in your objectives perhaps? Absolutely. I think it's also very important to know that we bring things to each other and that we have a positive influence on each other. On each other.

Interviewer: Yes, you'd say she's a positive influence?

Participant: Oh yes, totally, totally.

Interviewer: Do you have any other examples of positive influence?

Participant: Nutrition. The wède to eat quite healthily, so we sometimes indulge, but for the moment, the balance is quite positive, so it's okay. General health. Generally speaking, for example, I know that if I have a problem, I'm much more likely to go and see a dermatologist, an ophthalmologist, an optometrist, have some tests done. I'm not going to hurt the situation at hand, and say to myself "well, it's no big deal". And since some people turn 50 and say "I've lost my teeth, my hair's fallen out, I've got fat everywhere, I've got cholesterol, I've had two strokes", I can't imagine it. If only to never be out of breath again, to be in good physical health and to say to myself "ok, if not there's a zombie apocalypse, I won't be the first one to get eaten". It's silly, but I feel I'm gaining years of life. I can see the difference compared to other people or friends, the quality of life, the quality of energy on a daily basis compared to another period when my health was much worse. There really is a gain. I say to myself "okay, I don't need this coffee to get through the day, I'm efficient, I stay focused, I feel good, I'm not out of breath when I climb stairs, I walk enough". If someone told me I was in poor health, I'd still be very surprised. It would surprise me. It's really a relationship that benefits you on many levels. Yes, clearly. My next question is a bit related.

Interviewer: I'd like to know if you feel you're the same person you were before this relationship or if you feel the relationship has changed you.

Participant: I think the relationship has changed me. It's really changed me. Fundamentally, no, because I think I'm still a bit of a rough-hewn, awkward, direct, curious person. Deep down, my personality hasn't changed, but it's true that on the aspects that can change, on the aspect of eating well, sleeping well, having a healthy lifestyle, seeing people, listening, being quite serene, being quite sure of yourself. Yes, on the other hand, yes, clearly, it has changed me. Yes, it's not your deepest personality, but it's little characteristics that can evolve. Exactly.

Interviewer: Do you also have the impression that your partner, [Partner], may also have changed through the relationship, that she's evolved?

Participant: I think so, it's true that we talk about it sometimes. She tells me that she sees herself changing, that she's more confident, more assertive in her positions and relationships, less subject to the gaze of others. We talk about it quite frequently. Not this morning, but yesterday we were

talking about it. And in any case, from what she's told me, she sees a difference and she sees herself moving in a direction she likes. Yes, so she's gained a lot of self-confidence.

Interviewer: Yes. I'd also like you to tell me a little bit about yourself. Do you feel secure in this relationship?

Participant: Yes. On all levels, really, I have no worries. I know that, for example, in my life, my relationship, it's not something I worry about. It's really... Anything can happen. You can be safe from anything. Just because I'm in good health doesn't mean I don't want to get cancer tomorrow, because mathematically, it's totally possible according to the statistics. But I don't have any particular worries about my relationship, whether it's me on my side or me in relation to her. No, really, no worries. Yes, you feel that you can also, for example, open up to her, that you can share your thoughts, etc., without judgment. Yes, totally. She'll also be there to comfort you if you need it. That's it. All right, then. I'd also like to talk a little about sexuality, since we've already talked about it, and it's an important dimension.

Interviewer: So, [Name], I'd like to ask you if you don't mind the frequency of your intercourse.

Participant: I'm telling you right now, pretty much. Because I keep her diary, which also records sexual relations and so on. It's very practical. So, where is it? My calendar, my calendar. We're on about 4-5 times a month at the moment. That's right, 400 times. On average, yes. Maybe you've already talked a bit about it, but if we could come back to it, how important is sexual relations to you as a couple? It's true that it's important. I know it's less important for her. At the moment, we don't feel they need it as much. Afterwards, we realized that it's very much linked to ovulation too. There can be periods when, at first, you don't realize it, but at a certain point, I can know exactly which day I know she'll feel like it and which day she won't feel like it at all. That explains a lot and it's a lot easier that way. I think it's still important, but it doesn't have to be too frequent. Sometimes you feel the need and you know you're going to have a pattern where, she's going to be ovulating, you're going to have sex for the first time, not too long, to relieve the pressure, because you need it, but really mechanically and just as an animal, and you don't ask yourself the question. And other times we'll discuss it, we'll try things out, we'll have fun, it'll be really different and it'll be a bit more what we see and what we're looking for in sex. It's going to be really... We're going to go a lot further. But for us, it's still important. It's still important, but we know that we'll be fulfilled at some point when we're old, we won't have the desire anymore, but we'll still be relatively well aligned at that level, so we won't worry. For the moment, in any case, things are going very well. I think we've managed to operate in a way that's almost balanced. And for the future, we're not really worried. Once again, we come back to the question of view... We're opening up possibilities, and we know that if the mood takes us, we'll be able to try out other things. I'm not sure what else we'll be able to test, because we've already tested a few things. But it comes down to whether we want to test other things, or even elsewhere, or test things that are really particular or really different, we remain open, so in fact, there's no taboo, there's no limit. We talk about everything we want to test or not. So sometimes, there's a bit of a diognoma at the beginning, you don't really know how the other person is going to take it, I don't know, it's not done, it's weird. And in fact, afterwards, it's important to be able to talk about it. And finally, the frequency of intercourse, because compared to the start of the relationship, it's nothing like it was at the beginning, that's for sure. After [6-10] years, of course, we've tried things out. So, we still have urges, we still have urges, but it's much more controlled, it's

much more mastered, it's more cyclical, it's a bit more unusual. But we're going to try out different things, but we know it's always going to be about the same time. We'll have special times for that. Yes, but you're still pretty open about sexuality. Yes, it's still important. It's important that we're comfortable with it and that sex isn't a moment of embarrassment, of discomfort, where we don't feel good. We need to feel comfortable talking about it, we need to feel comfortable that it's a pleasure and that we're always discovering new sensations and that we're always vibrating like before. That's really important. So, would you say you're satisfied with the two of you, sorry, and with your sex life? Ah yes, 100%. Very much so.

Interviewer: So, to finish up, we're going to move on to a few small scales that I'm going to present to you. So, I've got to be able to show you. If it works. Normally... No, still not. No, it doesn't. Is this... Ah, I don't know if you can see. It loads and it's fine. So, you see the first question, if you had to mark from 1 to 9, in general, my partner really listens to me. Would you say 9?

Participant: Yes, in general, yes, at least 100%. Why would you say 9? In general, it's not all the time. We're on the... Is it more positive or not? Well, generally speaking, I don't say to myself "She listens to me", except when she doesn't. She listens to me. She listens to me, I know we're having a good discussion. It's really a small percentage. It's not even a percentage of the time we spend where I don't feel listened to. So it's really more than negligible. So, as a result, 9.

Interviewer: You've played well, it's changed a lot for you too.

Participant: My partner generally listens to my needs. So, 9. And why would you say 9? Why would I say 9 and not 8? I don't have a need where... I don't need to feel that I'm not understood, integrated and taken into account on her side. I feel she's really... She really listens to my needs. So she won't necessarily be able to respond right away, because sometimes needs are complicated. It takes time, we've got other things to do. But I know that she's really listening, that she'll take... She'll take it into account. And I know that either she's going to have it in the back of her mind, or she's going to respond to a need relatively quickly. So, I totally agree that, yes, she's generally attentive to my needs.

Interviewer: That's great. And then, for the last one, how satisfied are you with your relationship, saying that at the very least, you'd be completely satisfied?

Participant: All of a sudden, completely satisfied? Completely satisfied. Completely satisfied, yes. Ah yes. So, sorry, that's not the right... So, to dig a little deeper, how satisfied would you be with your relationship, I think you'd have to say from 0 to 10. 10. It wouldn't change a thing, frankly. Yeah. And really, if I had to redo things, go back in time, I'd redo everything exactly the same so that the relationship would be exactly the way it is now. Really, it would change absolutely nothing.

Interviewer: And then it comes up a bit, why 10 and not 9? What makes you give 10?

Participant: What makes me give 10? There's really no aspect where I say to myself "Oh yeah, no, but that's useful for a while". No, really, I'm totally satisfied on every level. So it's not all the time, there are always aspects where this morning, okay, we had a little argument, but looking back, I say to myself every time, even at the time of the argument, you can't be H24, perfect, perfect couple, a thousand and two, who get along perfectly well. It's normal not to get along all the time. And for me, it's normal. It's part of the thing. It's like an athlete who has curves to pull, it's a bit normal. It's part

of the game. And yes, really, I wouldn't change anything and I wouldn't do anything to make my relationship worse or if I had to do things differently, I wouldn't improve anything, I wouldn't send anything, I wouldn't move anything, frankly, it's not going perfectly as it is at the moment. Yes, the relationship doesn't stop at the end of the line. Yes, 100%, I'm exceptionally satisfied at this level, really, there's nothing to say.

Interviewer: Yes, listen, we're coming to the end. Thank you very much. I'll stop the re-recording next door.